

of the major responsibilities of the publisher. The success of a game depends on the scope of its distribution. Publishers offer a wide range of distribution channels and possibilities for promoting your game using their expertise and reach. You can distribute your game in physical form in game CDs or in digital forms through internet. Digital distributors such as STEAM, On Live, and Netflix etc have maintained a reputation in digital distribution. You can reach mass markets by distributing your games through Facebook. Whatever medium of distribution you choose, it is important to understand the pros and cons effectively.

IV. The aftermath

When the game has been released, most of the developers need their time to recover from the hectic crunch time. However, there is one final phase that needs to be tackled before the developer is completely over the project. Post-release phase is where you plan what more you can do to increase the lifespan of your game and to keep your players stay with your game.

Planning updates

Developers usually release updates to their game to make more money out of the game and to keep the players interested in the game. These updates can be some added achievements, a new festive level, a free add-on or any other kind of upgrade. Today it is very common to release updates to your game on casual game platforms like iPhone as it keeps your target audience plugged-in to your game and increases your revenue potential.

Planning sequels

While players keep moaning about the existence of sequels quoting that there's no innovation, repeated mechanics etc. the reason why publishers and developers develop, ship and sell sequels to successful or moderately successful games is that "Players do buy sequels no matter what they say". Publishers and developers publish sequels to mitigate the risk involved in the creation of a new IP/title. There are several reasons why sequels are developed:

- ▶ Proven technology
- ▶ Opportunity to make the game better and incorporate feedback
- ▶ Use of potential unused assets of the previous title
- ▶ Promised buyers